

Presentation Prep — AI Value-Creation Marketing Plan

Run-of-show, speaker split, reveal discipline, and Q&A playbook

Internal kit for Connor & Fiona — ENT 105 / Creo

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The one rule: rigor over hype — and propose, don’t impose. This plan’s whole edge is that Creo is the voice that *won’t* overclaim AI in a market drowning in AI claims. So the presentation has to *model* that discipline. Lead with the honest insight — **AI value is a map, not a multiplier**, and the durable play is a **swap, not a purge**. Present the AI direction as our *evidence-based recommendation* (Creo decides — we’re not imposing it), and meet the credibility question head-on instead of dodging it. **Never sell AI harder than the evidence** — overselling is the exact failure mode the positioning is built to exploit, so doing it on stage would sink the whole pitch.

Contents

1	Who presents what	2
2	Run of show (the flagship segment)	2
3	The reveal discipline — the depth ladder	3
4	Q&A playbook	3
4.1	“Everyone says they do AI — why believe Creo?” (Bryan — the core probe)	4
4.2	“Does Creo actually have the AI chops to deliver this?” (Rich / Akshita — the make-or-break)	4
4.3	“Isn’t this just McKinsey QuantumBlack / BCG X / Bain / the Big Four?” (Bryan / Chelsi)	4
4.4	“Is the AI roll-up real, or just hype?” (Rich)	4
4.5	“1000:1 — won’t AI just replace these workers?” (anyone)	4
4.6	“Your ‘reselection’ idea — isn’t that just layoffs?” (Akshita)	4
4.7	“Where’s the Microsoft data from?” (Bryan)	5
4.8	“What would a sponsor actually pay for?” (Rich)	5
4.9	“Can a boutique really compete here?” (Rich / strategy)	5
4.10	“This seems obvious.” (Bryan / Chelsi — name it first)	5
4.11	“How do you prove the value was actually created, post-deal?” (Akshita / Rich) . . .	5

5	The hard stop (post-deal measurement)	5
6	Landmines — do not	6
7	The Value-Creation Bridge — held as the “measured proof” close	6

1 Who presents what

- **[Fiona] Narrative & positioning.** The problem, the big idea, the “so what,” the campaign, the ask. Owns the room’s attention and the story arc.
- **[Connor] Quant depth & Q&A.** The ratio map, the worked numbers (CAC/LTV, the rehire-fraction read), the competitive gap, and every probe. Goes exactly as deep as the questioner pushes — no deeper.

Rule of thumb: *Fiona makes them want it; Connor makes them believe it.*

2 Run of show (the flagship segment)

#	Beat	Key message	Who
1	The problem	“PE’s hottest play is the AI roll-up. But buyers are pricing deals on hype ratios with no rigorous way to tell what’s real — and most AI programs show <i>no</i> return.”	[Fiona]
2	The big idea	“AI value is a <i>map</i> , not a multiplier. Creo’s market is telling buyers which functions are which — before they overpay for the average or gut the business chasing it.”	[Fiona]
3	The two maps	The <i>function</i> map (Collapse ~10,000:1 / Amplify ~3:1 / Level-up / Keep-human) <i>and</i> the <i>reselection</i> map (who can be amplified; can management run the swap).	[Connor]
4	Amplify, not replace	The Microsoft template: cut 15,000+ while <i>man-dating</i> AI and shielding its AI teams. “The rehire fraction is the readout of the real ratio — amplification, not 1000:1.”	[Connor]
5	The offer	“The AI-Automatability Diagnostic — an independent, buyer-side read. Free mini → productized → engagement → recurring.”	[Fiona]/[Connor]
6	Own the credibility	“This only works if Creo is <i>demonstrably</i> real on AI. Here’s the orchestrate-don’t-build model and the AI-staffing recommendation — we say this out loud.”	[Fiona]
7	The campaign	“How Creo turns it into pipeline: the annual AI Reality Report → founder LinkedIn → roundtable → a complimentary mini-Diagnostic.”	[Fiona]
8	The ask	What we recommend Creo do next: own the independent AI-diligence seat, launch the report, decide the AI-staffing path.	[Fiona]

The four-bucket colour-code (Collapse / Amplify / Level-up / Keep-human) carries from the plan — keep it consistent on the slides.

3 The reveal discipline — the depth ladder

For every core claim, have three levels ready and *stop at the level the question demands*:

- **L1 — the room.** One sentence, no jargon. (Fiona, or Connor opening.)
- **L2 — the analyst.** The mechanics, in Connor’s own coursework — the ratios, the rehire-fraction read, CAC/LTV, and the research lineage. (For Bryan / Akshita / Chelsi.)
- **L3 — the boundary.** Only the *post-deal measurement* (the Value-Creation Bridge) reaches here: one line — “that’s our proprietary measurement methodology; the applied version is self-contained and reconciles to the dollar” — nothing to defend; then return to the plan.

Claim	L1 (room)	L2 (Connor’s depth)
Map, not multiplier	“AI helps different jobs by wildly different amounts.”	A business is a portfolio of functions: pure coordination collapses (~10,000:1), knowledge work amplifies (~3:1), judgment/physical/regulated stays ~1:1. Value lives in the mix — almost no one measures it.
Swap, not purge	“Keep your best people, give them AI, drop the busy-work.”	Reselection: amplify the operators who understand the business, collapse the coordination layer, re-select for AI-fluent talent — without breaking quality. Gut-and-replace is why most programs show no return.
The rehire is the tell	“If you fire 15k and rehire thousands, AI didn’t replace them.”	The rehire <i>fraction</i> reads out the real ratio: rehire a sizable share $\Rightarrow$ amplification (low single digits), not 1000:1. Public template: Microsoft 2025.
Rigorous diagnostic	“We show our work — no black box.”	Grounded in occupational-exposure research (Frey–Osborne task classes; the OpenAI “exposure $\neq$ automation” caveat); two axes (function + reselection); transparent.

4 Q&A playbook

The probes this panel will actually throw, with the answer at the right depth. ([**Connor**] fields the quant ones; [**Fiona**] the positioning ones, as marked.)

4.1 “Everyone says they do AI — why believe Creo?” (Bryan — the core probe)

L1: “That *is* the position. The market is full of people overclaiming AI; Creo is the independent, buyer-side voice that won’t — we tell you what AI *can’t* durably do.” **L2:** “And we don’t dodge our own credibility (next answer). The Diagnostic is buyer-side *assessment*, not us claiming to build everything — the neutrality is the scarce asset in a hype market.”

4.2 “Does Creo actually have the AI chops to deliver this?” (Rich / Akshita — the make-or-break)

“Straight answer: the position only works if Creo is demonstrably real on AI, so we’re recommending you *close that gap deliberately* — orchestrate, don’t build: Creo is the independent diligence-and-architecture brain; specialist vendors do the build. Whether you add a senior AI hire, partner, or embed one is a live decision — and we’d vet any hire with Creo’s own ‘is this AI real?’ rigor.” (*Owning this openly is a strength — it proves the rigor-over-hype brand.*)

4.3 “Isn’t this just McKinsey QuantumBlack / BCG X / Bain / the Big Four?” (Bryan / Chelsi)

L1: “They sell broad transformation and *the build* — which makes their read conflicted. No one owns the independent, buyer-side, diligence-grade seat.” **L2:** “Bain works with ~80% of the largest sponsors; BCG owns ‘reshape.’ We don’t out-scale them — we *flank* them on independence, deal-level rigor, and the reselection read they don’t do. A boutique wins on focus and distribution, not size.”

4.4 “Is the AI roll-up real, or just hype?” (Rich)

“Real and funded — Elad Gil’s thesis, General Catalyst (Long Lake took Amex GBT private for \$6.3B), Thrive Holdings — across legal, accounting, IT, BPO, healthcare. *But* the returns aren’t there yet: BCG finds only ~5% capture real value while 60% lag, and ~95% of GenAI pilots fail. That gap — hot strategy, no rigorous read — is precisely the opening.”

4.5 “1000:1 — won’t AI just replace these workers?” (anyone)

“No — that’s the hype the plan corrects. The handoff is a *map*: ~3:1 in knowledge work, ~10,000:1 only in pure coordination (the Uber dispatch layer), ~1:1 in judgment, physical, relationship, and regulated work. Price the mix, not the average.”

4.6 “Your ‘reselection’ idea — isn’t that just layoffs?” (Akshita)

“It’s a *swap*, not a *purge*. You keep and amplify the people who truly understand the business, collapse the busywork, and re-select for AI-fluent talent — without breaking quality. Gut-and-replace is the failure mode: Klarna went AI-only on support and had to re-hire humans.”

4.7 “Where’s the Microsoft data from?” (Bryan)

“Public record: Microsoft cut 15,000+ in 2025, made AI use ‘no longer optional’ and tied it to performance reviews (the Liuson memo), and shielded its AI/Copilot teams from the 2026 freeze — all reported and sourced in the plan. We use only the documented version.” (*Stay on the sourced facts — don’t speculate past the public record.*)

4.8 “What would a sponsor actually pay for?” (Rich)

[Fiona]/[Connor]: “An independent read that *reprices the deal* — tells them what the target is really worth once you strip the hype ratio. Entry is a free mini-Diagnostic; it ladders to a productized Diagnostic, an amplification engagement, and a recurring portfolio read.”

4.9 “Can a boutique really compete here?” (Rich / strategy)

“Not on scale — on focus, independence, credibility, and *distribution*: your warm sponsor relationships are an edge the big firms can’t buy. Being first to own the independent ‘what can durably be automated, and can this business execute the swap’ seat is the moat.”

4.10 “This seems obvious.” (Bryan / Chelsi — name it first)

Pre-empt it; say it before they do. “This is going to feel obvious the moment we draw the map — and that’s the point; the best frameworks do. The opportunity is that *nobody in your market actually does it* — they’re all still pricing AI at one hype multiple. Obvious-but- nobody-does-it is the most ownable position there is.” *Welcome the reaction — it means they believe it. It’s the good reaction, not a threat.*

4.11 “How do you prove the value was actually created, post-deal?” (Akshita / Rich)

“We close the loop with independent measurement — the Value-Creation Bridge — separating real operational gains from value merely transferred. Diligence → amplification → *measured* result.” **If pushed past the applied method:** the hard-stop line below — then back to the plan.

5 The hard stop (post-deal measurement)

The *only* place a deflection is needed is the post-deal measurement (the Bridge). Use verbatim, if pushed past the applied method:

- **The hard stop:** “That’s our proprietary measurement methodology — the applied method here is self-contained and, as you can see, reconciles to the dollar.” Then return to the plan.

Keep it to that line and move on. Do **not** gesture at any larger body of theory, and do **not** reference formal proofs or verification of any kind — you won’t be able to field the follow-up, and you don’t need to.

6 Landmines — do not

- **Don't oversell Creo's current AI capability.** Be honest about the gap and the build/partner plan — overclaiming is the exact thing the brand critiques.
- **Don't claim 1000:1 / wholesale replacement.** It's a map and amplification; the ratios are illustrative orders of magnitude, not constants.
- **Stick to the public record on Microsoft** — only the documented facts (the cuts, the “AI is no longer optional” memo, the AI teams shielded from the freeze). Don't speculate past what's sourced.
- **Don't promise to build the AI systems.** Orchestrate, don't build — Creo is the independent brain; vendors build.
- **Don't impose the AI direction.** It's our *recommendation*; lead by understanding what management wants, and adapt if they want something else.
- **Don't invoke “formally verified,” a “proof,” or any larger framework** behind the measurement. Keep it to the proprietary-methodology line and return to the plan.
- **Don't assert self-reported market figures as fact** (Bain's “80%,” vendor allocations) — attribute them.

7 The Value-Creation Bridge — held as the “measured proof” close

The Bridge is no longer the headline — it's the credibility *close*. If the panel presses on “how do you know the value was real?”, bring it in: “Post-deal, we measure it independently — splitting operational value *created* from value merely *transferred* (multiple, leverage, tax), reconciled to the dollar. That's how the Diagnostic's promise is held to account.” Otherwise keep it to one line — “and we measure the result” — and hold the spotlight on the AI plan. (Backing exhibit: the Value-Creation Bridge one-pager + practitioner's guide, in reserve.)

Internal prep for Connor & Fiona. Flagship exhibit: the AI Value-Creation Marketing Plan (“AI value is a map, not a multiplier”). The Bridge measurement is held in reserve as the proof-of-result close — a proprietary methodology, not detailed here; the credibility you present is the evidence and the numbers reconciling — never an AI claim you can't back.